

SIDE SLIPPING

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #111

There are a million ways to "play out," and the idea of Side Slipping (playing a half step above or below the harmony) is just one of them. And it is that simple . . . play a half step away from the chord change you see. OK, if it's so simple, though, why is it so dang hard?! Two main reasons.

- 1) Tension requires (or at least implies) a release. You have to learn to release the tension you build. Otherwise, it just sounds like a mistake.
- 2) Playing a half step away is, technically speaking, super-wrong! An organizing element helps a lot. Things like repetition, strong melodic content, historical language, rhythmic elements and so on. Your "out stuff" will sound better and more confident if you help the listener make some sense of what you are doing.

Speak Low - "A" section (Kurt Weill)

The image displays four staves of musical notation for the "A" section of "Speak Low" by Kurt Weill. Each staff contains four measures of music, represented by a treble clef, a key signature of one flat (Bb), and a 4/4 time signature. The chords for each measure are as follows:

- Staff 1: Gm⁷, C⁷, Gm⁷, C⁷
- Staff 2: Gm⁷, C⁷, Gm⁷, C⁷, A^ø⁷, D⁷
- Staff 3: Bbm⁷, Eb⁷, Bbm⁷, Eb⁷
- Staff 4: Dm⁷, G⁷, Gm⁷, C⁷, Fmaj⁷, Am⁷, D⁷

Red annotations highlight specific side-slipping instances:

- A red oval circles the first two measures of Staff 2 (Gm⁷ and C⁷).
- A red oval circles the first two measures of Staff 3 (Bbm⁷ and Eb⁷).
- A red oval circles the fifth measure of Staff 4 (Fmaj⁷).
- Red arrows point from the third measure of Staff 2 (Gm⁷) to the fourth measure (C⁷), from the third measure of Staff 3 (Bbm⁷) to the fourth measure (Eb⁷), and from the sixth measure (Am⁷) to the seventh measure (D⁷).